

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ J 10 9 5
♦ 8 7 3 2
♣ 7 5 2

♠ A 9 7 6
♥ A Q 4
♦ A J 4
♣ Q 10 8



♠ K J 5 2
♥ 8 6 3
♦ K 10 9
♣ A 6 4

♠ 10 8 4
♥ K 7 2
♦ Q 6 5
♣ K J 9 3

With 9 points SOUTH is unable to decide the final contract. If NORTH has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If NORTH opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So SOUTH makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells NORTH that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal NORTH has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠ 2			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 7
♥ Q 6 5 4 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ Q 3

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A 7 3

♦ 10 8 4

♣ 8 7 4



♠ 8 5 3

♥ J 10

♦ K Q 6 3

♣ A J 6 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ A J 2

♣ K 10 9 5

This time SOUTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

NORTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

SOUTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			
2NT by South			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 5 3
♥ K 9 7 6 4 2
♦ 7 5 3
♣ 6

♠ K Q 6
♥ A J 10 3
♦ A Q
♣ K J 5 2



♠ A 9 8
♥ Q
♦ K 10 9 8 6
♣ A Q 10 4

♠ J 7 4 2
♥ 8 5
♦ J 4 2
♣ 9 8 7 3

NORTH has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

SOUTH adds her 2 points to NORTH's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

*West**North*
2NT*East**South*

All Pass

2NT by North

Lead: ♦ 10

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 5 4
♥ K 6 5 4 3
♦ A 7
♣ A 5 3

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 10 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 9 2

♥ J 8

♦ 6 5 3 2

♣ 6 4 2

♠ A 10 8

♥ A 10 9

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ K 9 7

SOUTH has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

NORTH has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking SOUTH to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But SOUTH has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7 3
♥ 10 9 8 6 2
♦ A 7
♣ 5 4 2

♠ K Q J
♥ A 4
♦ K Q 10 8
♣ A J 7 3



♠ A 5 4
♥ Q J 3
♦ J 6 3 2
♣ 10 9 8

♠ 10 9 6 2
♥ K 7 5
♦ 9 5 4
♣ K Q 6

NORTH has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

SOUTH has 8 points. She adds NORTH's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and NORTH passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♥Q